

- ◆ It has a built in terminal to quickly access OS commands.
- ◆ You can customise your development environment through custom commands

Cons

- ◆ The IDE is quite powerful but it still lacks a WYSIWYG which would have been beneficial in quickly developing small or mid-level, less code intensive, websites.

BASIC COMPARISON

	Aptana Studio	Adobe Dreamweaver
Price	Free	Rs 1000/month CS6 Rs 29, 484
Platform	Windows, Mac and Linux	Windows and Mac
WYSIWYG	No	Yes
Technology supported	HTML, JavaScript, CSS, Ruby, Rails, Python and PHP	HTML, CSS, ASP, ASPX, ASR, CFC, CFM, FLV, JAVA, PHP, SWF, XML, and much more
FTP upload	Yes	Yes
Version Control	Yes	Yes
Customisable workspace	Yes	Yes

ALTERNATIVE PICK - MICROSOFT EXPRESSIONS WEB

Although it is not technically an OSS, it is free for use and comes in a close second as it is feature rich and supports HTML5. It is however limited to windows and further development has been stopped for it. It's extremely flexible and familiar WYSIWYG interface brings it to a close second and also because of the fact that it has most of the features of Adobe Dreamweaver.

TAKING IT OUT FOR A SPIN

We decided to create a simple webpage in both Dreamweaver and Aptana Studio to see how similar or different the process is of creating the webpage.

Aptana Studio

- ◆ Aptana does not have a WYSIWYG interface but has a code editor so it did involve a number of steps. But here, we had complete control of